Barrier Breakers 2027

High School Entrepreneurship Competition

Cash Prizes • Date & Host Campus Coming Soon

High schoolers in Northeast Ohio: build a venture that breaks a real financial barrier, bring something to show, and pitch it to a panel of judges. Five teams go on to Demo Day.

🚗 **Transportation**

🏠 **Housing**

🏥 **Healthcare**

📚 **Financial Literacy**

🌟 **Your Own Idea**

📋 How It Works

- **RSVP as a team** (1-3 students)
- **Pick a barrier** from the list above, or bring your own. Nothing to declare.
- **Build the venture** — app, product, service, program, or policy. Work out who pays and who runs it. AI tools welcome.
- **Bring something to show** (poster, prototype, app, 3D print) and **pitch it in 60 seconds** to three judges, then take questions
- **Five finalists** present for five minutes at Demo Day that afternoon. Every team should have that version ready too.

🎯 Why Bring Your Students

- Every team is judged by the same three-person panel as everyone in their section
- Customer research, a business model, and a pitch they'll remember
- University campus visit opportunity
- Face time with founders, investors, and business professionals
- Portfolio-building project for college apps

🏆 Prize Categories

Demo Day (5 Finalists)

Ranked 1st through 5th
Cash to the team

Honorable Mentions

Each section's runner-up
Recognized at the awards

Knowledge Track

Optional financial literacy quiz over lunch
Small cash prizes for the top scores

Ready to Participate?

No limit on teams — everyone who RSVPs competes. 2027 prize pool announced with sponsors; 2026 awarded $20,000+.

Event Details →

Learn More →

Questions? Contact **competition@finmango.org** | **finmango.org/barrier-breakers**